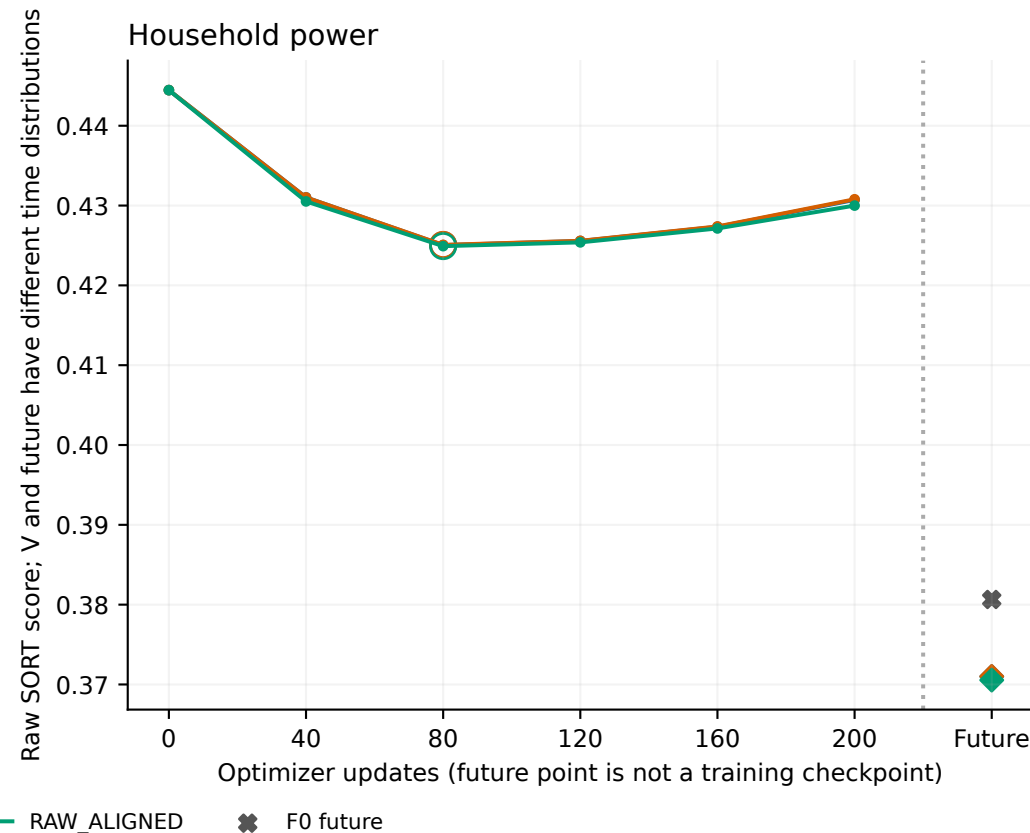
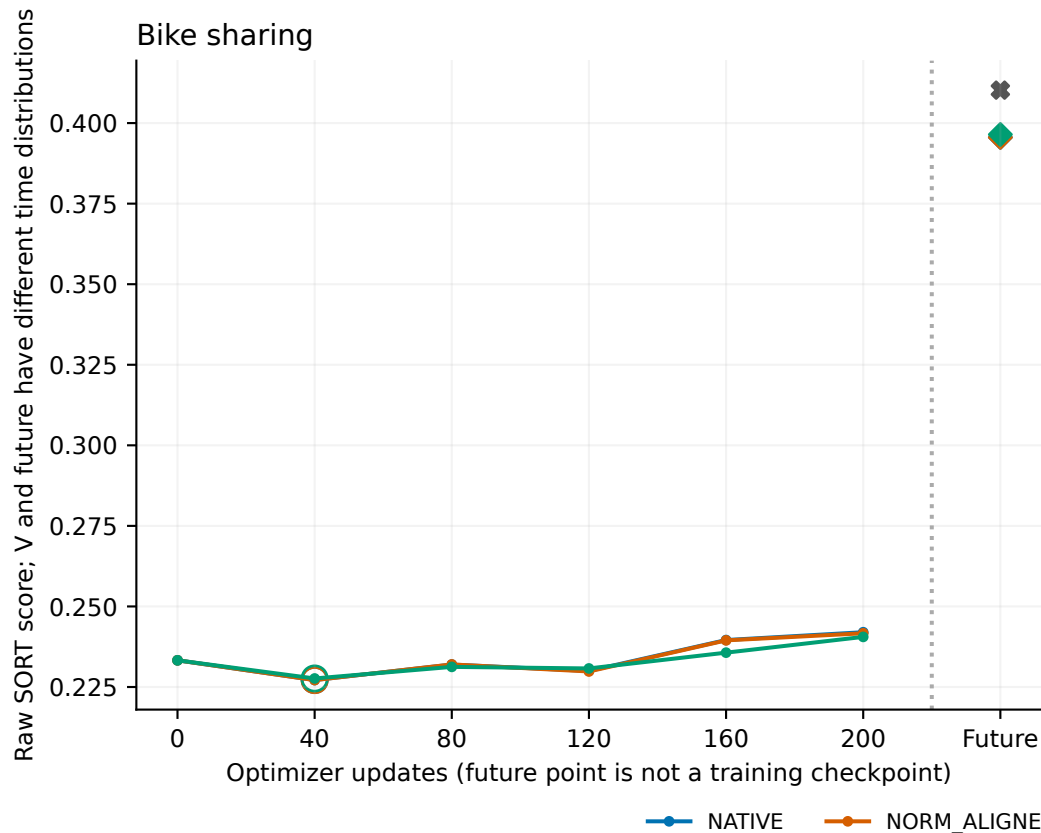


# Validation trajectories and the fixed future evaluation

Lines: raw SORT validation at six fixed checkpoints · diamonds: selected checkpoint's future SORT score



Development diagnostic: two previously evaluated sources, one optimizer seed (12000), LR 3e-5, 200 updates.

Initial gradient norms are matched; AdamW updates and subsequent clipping are not matched. This is not a novel PEFT method.

Primary: SORT NORM\_ALIGNED minus RAW\_ALIGNED, divided by SORT F0. Date-block CIs exclude training uncertainty.